Budget Template



Use This Template

Use this page whenever you need a clean budget outside a lesson.
You may use a real, sample, or fictional scenario.

Remember

Income – Expenses – Savings = Balance

Savings is part of the plan, but it is not counted inside Total Expenses.

01 | My Budget

Income

Income Source	Amount
	$ _____
	$ _____
	$ _____
Total Income	$ _____

02 | Expenses

Expense	Fixed or Variable?	Amount
Housing / Household Contribution	_____	$ _____
Food / Groceries	_____	$ _____
Transportation	_____	$ _____
Phone / Technology	_____	$ _____
Other Essential Expense	_____	$ _____
Entertainment / Hobbies	_____	$ _____
Personal / Optional Spending	_____	$ _____
Other	_____	$ _____
Total Expenses	—	$ _____

03 | Savings

Savings Goal: $ _____

04 | Check the Balance

$ _____ Income – $ _____ Expenses – $ _____ Savings = $ _____ Balance

What Does the Balance Show?

More than $0:
Money remains. Decide whether it will stay as a cushion or be assigned somewhere else.

Exactly $0:
All available income has been assigned.

Less than $0:
The plan uses more money than is available. Something needs to change.

05 | One Adjustment I Could Make _____

_____

Spending Tracker Template

Use This Template

A spending tracker helps you notice where money is going. You may track actual spending, rounded spending, or a fictional weekly scenario.

WISE Tip

Small purchases count too. Patterns are easier to see when the tracker is complete.



01 | Weekly Spending Tracker

Date / Day	What Was Purchased	Category	Amount
			$ _____
			$ _____
			$ _____
			$ _____
			$ _____
			$ _____
			$ _____
			$ _____
			$ _____

02 | Category Totals

Category	Total
Food / Groceries	$ _____
Transportation	$ _____
Phone / Technology	$ _____
Entertainment	$ _____
School / Work	$ _____
Personal / Shopping	$ _____
Family / Community Support	$ _____
Other	$ _____
Total Spending	**$ _____**

Savings

Amount intentionally set aside for savings this week: $ _____

03 | Look for a Pattern

Which category had the highest spending?

_____

Was anything different from what you expected?

_____

_____

04 | Reflect

What is one choice you would keep the same? Why?

_____

_____

What is one choice you might change? Why?

_____

_____

Savings Goal Planner

My Goal Progress

$0 Target: $_____

Target Date

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat

Before You Start

Use a real, sample, fictional, or aspirational goal.

Remember

A savings plan needs **three things:**
A target · A timeline · A recurring amount.

01 | Name the Goal

Goal: _____

Target Amount: $ _____

Already Saved: $ _____

02 | Find the Amount Still Needed

$ _____ (Target) − $ _____ (Already Saved) = $ _____ (Still Needed)

03 | Choose How to Build the Plan

If You Know the Timeline

Amount Still Needed ÷ Number of Months = Monthly Savings Needed

$ _____ (Amount Still Needed) ÷ _____ months (Number of Months) = $ _____ (Monthly Savings Needed)

If You Know What You Can Save Each Month

Amount Still Needed ÷ Monthly Savings Amount = Months Needed

$ _____ (Amount Still Needed) ÷ $ _____ (Monthly Savings Amount) = _____ months (Months Needed)

04 | Plan for a Barrier

One thing that could make the plan harder to follow:

_____

_____

One strategy that could help:

_____

_____

05 | Choose a Savings System

- ☐ Savings account
- ☐ Cash envelope or savings jar
- ☐ Automatic transfer, if available
- ☐ Another safe system: _____

Why does this system fit the goal or situation?

_____

_____

06 | Check the Plan

- ☐ I know the target amount.
- ☐ I know how much is still needed.
- ☐ My recurring savings amount and timeline work together.
- ☐ I have a strategy for a possible barrier.

SMART Goal Planner

What SMART Means

S	Specific	What exactly is the goal?
M	Measurable	How much money is needed?
A	Achievable	What recurring amount or action can support the goal?
R	Relevant	Why does this goal matter?
T	Time-bound	When will the goal be reached?

01 Build the Goal

Complete each part of the SMART goal.

SMART Part	My Plan
S — Specific	_____
M — Measurable	$ _____
A — Achievable	_____
R — Relevant	_____
T — Time-bound	_____

02 Monthly Savings Check

If the goal requires saving:
Goal Amount ÷ Number of Months = Monthly Savings Needed

$ _____ ÷ _____ months = $ _____ per month

03 Complete Goal Statement

I will save $ _____ for _____ by _____
by saving $ _____ per month.

04 Support Plan

One barrier that could get in the way:	One strategy that could help:	One person, resource, reminder, or system that could support the plan:
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

05 If the Plan Changes

What could you adjust without giving up the goal completely?

_____
_____

Formula Sheet

Why This Matters

Use this page when you need to check a formula or calculation from Dimension 1.

WISE Tip

First identify what each number means. Then choose the formula.

01 Budget Balance

Income − Expenses − Savings = Balance

Example: $1,200 − $765 − $150 = $285

02 Spending-Plan Order

Needs → Savings → Wants

Income − Needs = Money After Needs
Money After Needs − Savings = Money Available for Wants
Money Available for Wants − Wants = Final Balance

03 Monthly Savings Needed

Goal Amount ÷ Number of Months = Monthly Savings Needed

Example: $240 ÷ 6 = $40 per month

04 Savings Rate

Savings Amount ÷ Income × 100 = Savings Rate

Example: $40 ÷ $400 = 0.10 × 100 = 10%

05 Emergency Gap

Unexpected Cost − Emergency Savings Used = Remaining Gap

Example: $120 − $40 = $80

06 Simple Interest

$$I = P \times r \times t$$

Symbol	Meaning
I	Interest
P	Principal
r	Annual rate as a decimal
t	Time in years

Example: $500 × 0.04 × 3 = $60 interest

07 Rule of 72

Approximate Years to Double = 72 ÷ Annual Rate

Use the percentage as a whole number.

Example: At 6%, 72 ÷ 6 = about 12 years

08 Compound Growth (Simplified Annual Compounding)

$$A = P(1 + r)^t$$

Symbol	Meaning
A	Ending amount
P	Starting principal
r	Annual rate as a decimal
t	Time in years

09 General Future Cost Formula

Estimated Future Cost = Current Cost × (1 + assumed inflation rate)^n

10 3% Classroom Future Cost Formula

Estimated Future Cost = Current Cost × (1.03)^n

Years	Multiplier	Years	Multiplier
1	1.030	10	1.344
2	1.061	15	1.558
3	1.093	20	1.806
5	1.159		

Example: $300 × 1.159 = $347.70

11 Capstone I Monthly Available Income

Use the fictional monthly available-income amount supplied for the Capstone scenario. Do not calculate gross-to-net pay or payroll deductions in Capstone I; paycheck instruction is addressed in Unit 6.

12 Weekly ↔ Monthly Conversion

Weekly × 4.33 ≈ Monthly	Monthly ÷ 4.33 ≈ Weekly

Reflection Sentence Starters

Why This Matters

Sometimes you understand the idea but need help getting the explanation started. Use any of these sentence starters when a reflection or explanation feels difficult to begin.

Remember

You may use a personal, general, sample, or fictional example.

01 Noticing

- One thing I noticed is...
- What stood out to me was...
- I was surprised that...
- The number or detail that mattered most was...

02 Explaining the Math

- I started by...
- The number that changed was...
- This changed the final amount because...
- I know my answer is reasonable because...
- When I recalculated, I found that...

03 Making Connections

- This matters because...
- This connects to...
- One way this idea could affect a financial choice is...
- This example shows that...

04 Decisions & Trade-Offs

- One option is...
- Another option is...
- The trade-off would be...
- I would choose _____ because...
- This choice protects _____ but gives up _____.

05 Barriers & Strategies

- One barrier could be...
- A strategy that could help is...
- If the first strategy did not work, another option would be...
- One manageable next step is...

06 Money Mindset & Influences

- This belief may have come from...
- Another way to look at the belief is...
- The situation matters because...
- Two people could make different choices because...

07 Values & Goals

- This goal connects to the value of...
- This value matters because...
- One step toward the goal is...
- If the plan stopped working, I could adjust...

08 Looking Back

- I used to think...
- Now I understand...
- One skill that became easier is...
- One question I still have is...
- My next step is...

Digital Companions

What this page is for

Use this page to find the right digital companion for each lesson. Each companion lets you try a choice, see what happens, and bring one idea back to your workbook.

Start by finding your lesson in the tables below.

QR PLACEHOLDER
not a working code

Open the Hub

Scan the QR code or type the web address.

approved beacwise.com address

No login. No account. Nothing is saved.

How to use a companion

1. **Find it** — Look for your lesson or workbook page below.
2. **Open it** — Scan the code or type the address.
3. **Try it** — Go through the activity and change one thing.
4. **Write it down** — Go back to your workbook and note one thing you noticed.

Use sample or fictional information only. | **No device?** You can still complete the lesson in your workbook.

Unit 1 — Budgeting & Planning

DIGITAL COMPANION	WORKBOOK CONNECTION	WHAT IT HELPS YOU DO
1 — Devon's Month	p. 12; Real-World Research p. 13	Live through Devon's month, respond to changes, and compare the result with the budget you built on p. 12.
2 — Priority Shift	pp. 16–17 and p. 20; Real-World Research p. 21	See how safety shoes and a youth bus pass change priorities in Elijah's plan. Explain what changed in the situation and why it matters.
3 — Goal in Motion	Practice p. 28; Apply p. 29; Real-World Research p. 30	Follow Marcus's savings over several months. Adjust after a difficult month, decide what to do with a $15 gift, and compare the effect on his goal.

Unit 2 — Money Mindset & Values

DIGITAL COMPANION	WORKBOOK CONNECTION	WHAT IT HELPS YOU DO
4 — Mindset Paths	Apply p. 42; Reflect p. 43	Follow two possible thought-to-action paths after Elijah's money setback. Compare the next steps, then revisit your reframe on p. 42.
5 — Same Choice, Different Story	Practice p. 49; Apply p. 50	Investigate why two fictional students made different choices with the same $200 gift. Reveal influences and trace one money message before revisiting your map on p. 49.
6 — Goal Fit	Values p. 57; Apply p. 58	Stress-test a fictional Growth-based training goal when its price rises and deadline shortens. Compare changing the monthly amount, training option, or timeline.

Unit 3 — Saving, Interest & Inflation

DIGITAL COMPANION	WORKBOOK CONNECTION	WHAT IT HELPS YOU DO
7 — Emergency Ripple	Key Calculation p. 66; Apply p. 70; Real-World Research p. 71	Test a fictional $240 emergency-fund plan after a $120 repair. See how using savings changes the remaining gap and the time needed to rebuild.
8 — Interest in Motion	pp. 76–79	Watch simple and compound interest grow year by year. Change principal, annual rate, or time; compare Kate's sample storage choices and estimate doubling time.
9 — Purchasing Power Time Machine	pp. 84–87; Real-World Research p. 88	Change a goal's current cost and timeline under a fixed 3% inflation planning assumption. Then compare the growth of $100 with the changing cost of a basket.

Capstone I

DIGITAL COMPANION	WORKBOOK CONNECTION	WHAT IT HELPS YOU DO
10 — My Financial Future: Stress Test	Core plan pp. 93–98; optional research pp. 99–100; completion milestone p. 101	Stress-test the sample plan when income falls and rent rises. Rebalance savings and wants, adjust the goal if needed, and bring one observation back to the Capstone review.